

# Leadership?

Getting to know yourself, those around you, and working together  
(A light introduction!)

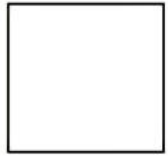
# Overview

- Pre-work: how to understand myself and others?
- Discussion: what can we really know and understand?
- Pre-work: what makes a “good” or “bad” leader?
- Discussion: what are some key leadership traits?
- Discussion: what is leadership meant to achieve?
- Discussion: what is leadership like in practice?
- Wrap-up: how to “be” and “work” best for myself and others

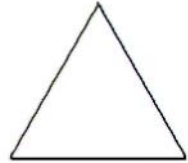
How to understand myself and others?



# Which do you like best and why?



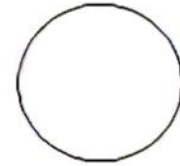
BOX



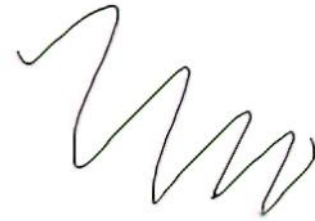
TRIANGLE



RECTANGLE



CIRCLE

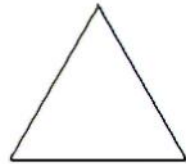


SQUIGGLE

# Which do you like best and why?



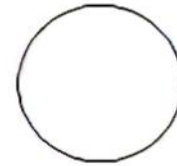
BOX



TRIANGLE



RECTANGLE



CIRCLE



SQUIGGLE

Do the indicators correlate with your personal style?

## BOX

Organized  
Detailed  
Knowledgeable  
Analytical  
Patient  
Persevering

## TRIANGLE

Leader  
Focused  
Decisive  
Ambitious  
Competitive  
Bottom-line

## RECTANGLE

In Transition  
Courageous  
Searching  
Inquisitive  
Growing

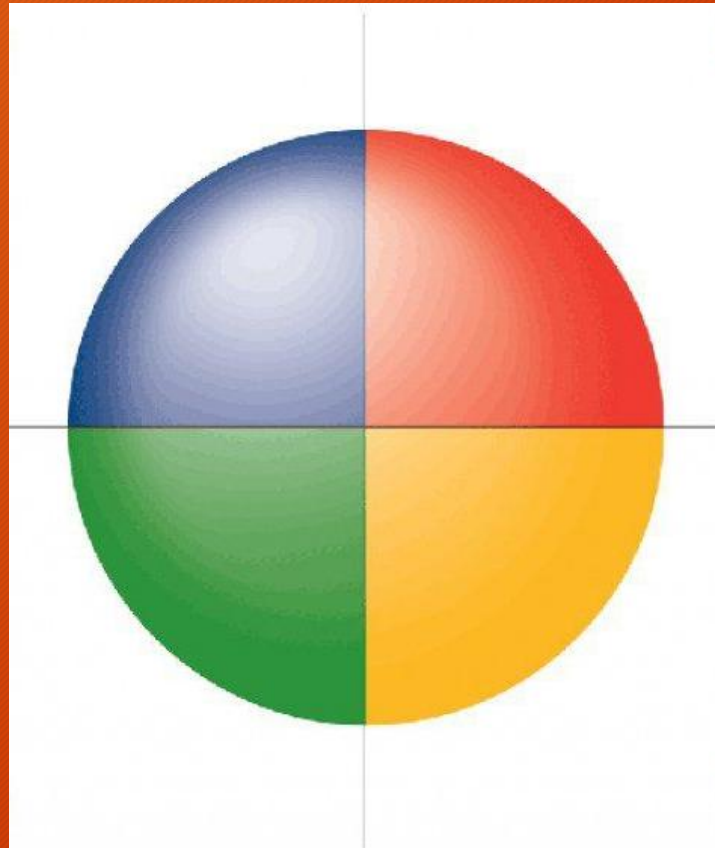
## CIRCLE

Friendly  
Nurturing  
Persuasive  
Empathetic  
Generous  
Stabilizing

## SQUIGGLE

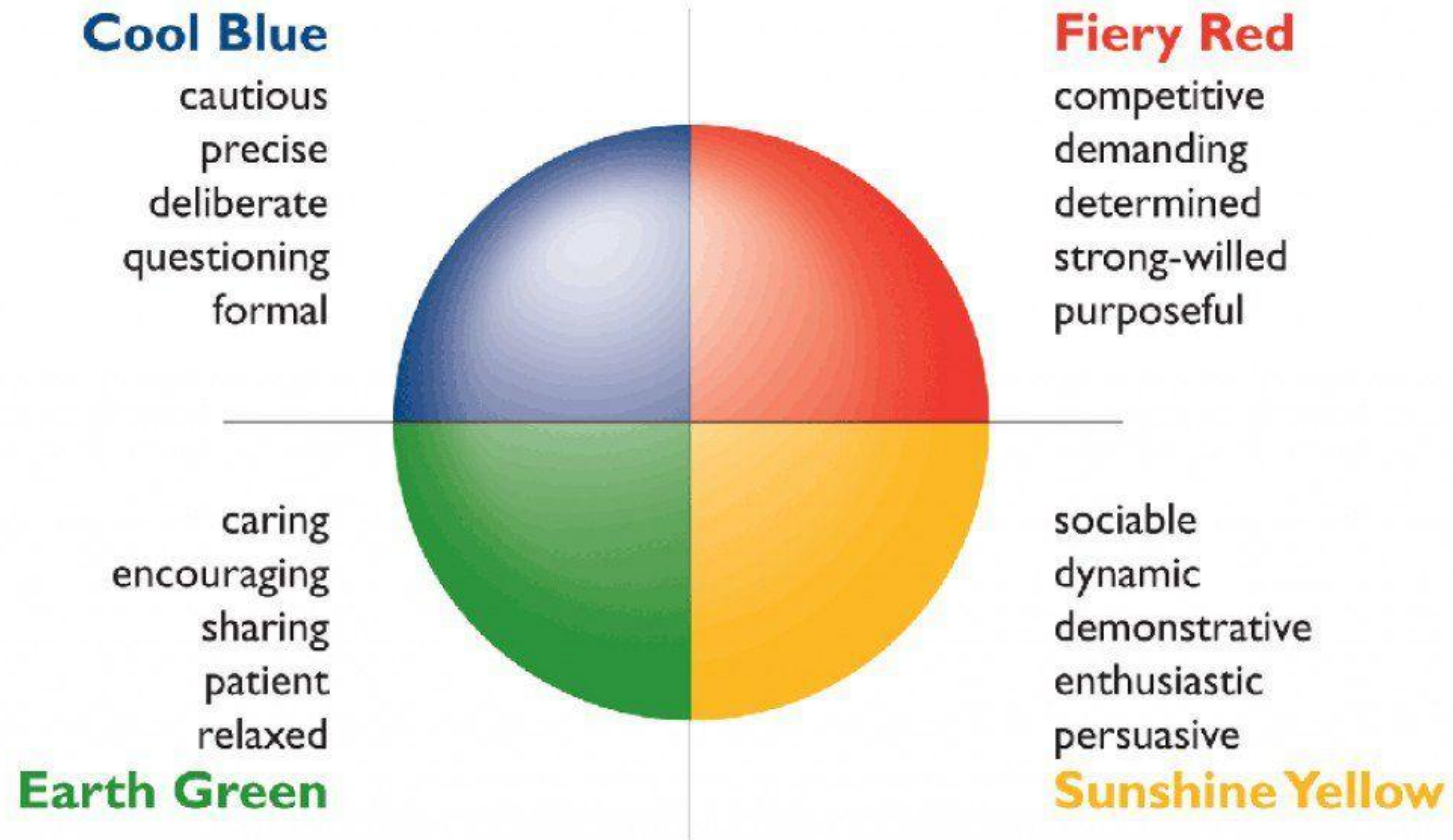
Creative  
Motivating  
Futuristic  
Intuitive  
Expressive  
Witty

Which do you like best and why?





# Which do you like best and why?



# Which do you like best and why?

- What do you think about the shapes and colours tests?
- Is all this bull-shit? If so, why?
- Why might it be useful?



# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

- Can we actually classify personalities?
- What do you think the key “features” of personality are?
- Why might it be useful?
- [Personality Test of Myers & Briggs' 16 Types | TypeFinder® \(truity.com\)](https://truity.com)



# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

Where do you  
get your energy  
from?

**E**

## Extraversion

Prefer to get their energy  
'externally': from activities and (a  
lot of) interaction with people.

**I**

## Introversion

Prefer to get their energy from  
themselves, "internally": from  
thoughts, feelings, ideas and some  
time spent alone to recharge the

Which type of  
information do  
you prefer?

**S**

## Sensing

Like to focus on information they  
can actually perceive (details) and  
on practical applications.

**N**

## Intuition

Prefer to focus on patterns,  
connections and possible meanings.

How do you  
make a  
decision?

**T**

## Thinking

Prefer to base decisions on logic  
and objective analysis of cause and  
effect.

**F**

## Feeling

Naturally consider what is  
important to other people when  
making decisions.

How do you  
plan your life  
and work?

**J**

## Judging

Preference for living a planned and  
organized life

**P**

## Perceiving

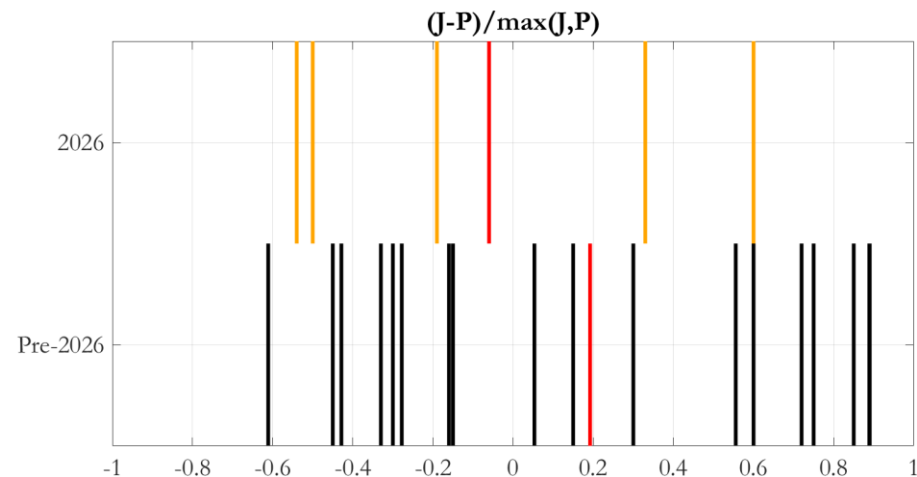
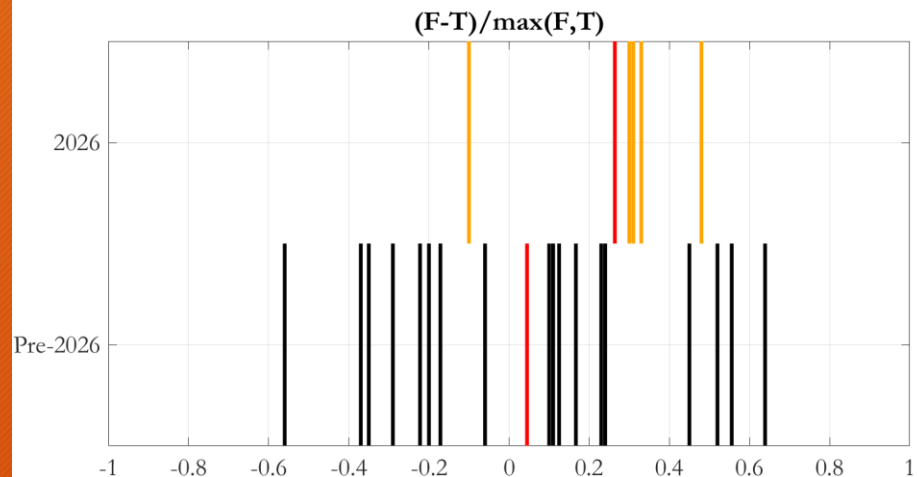
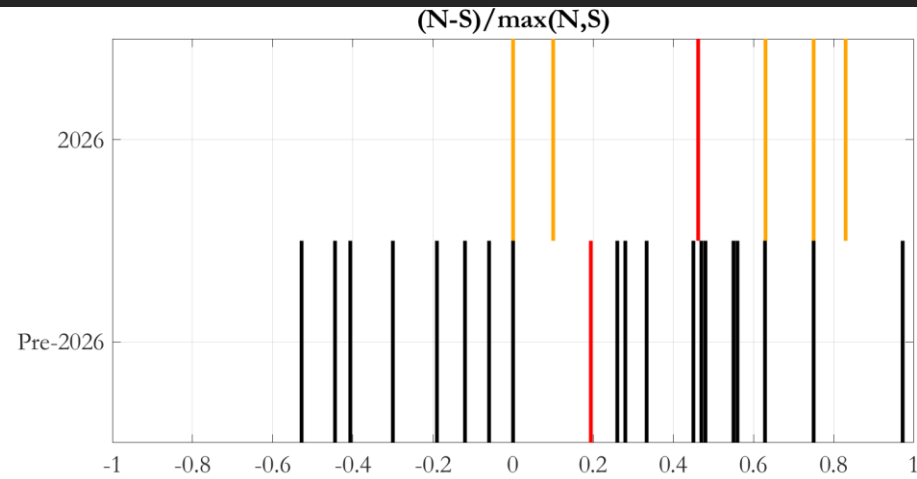
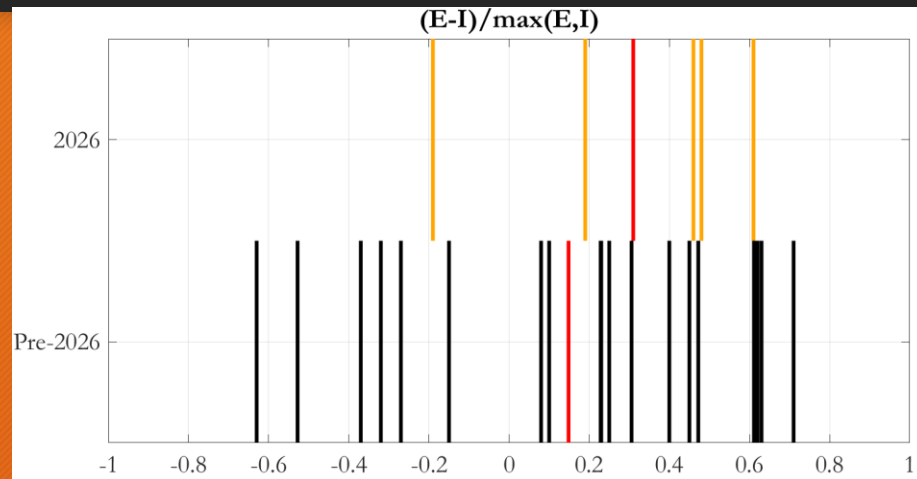
Like a flexible, spontaneous  
approach and prefer to keep  
options open.

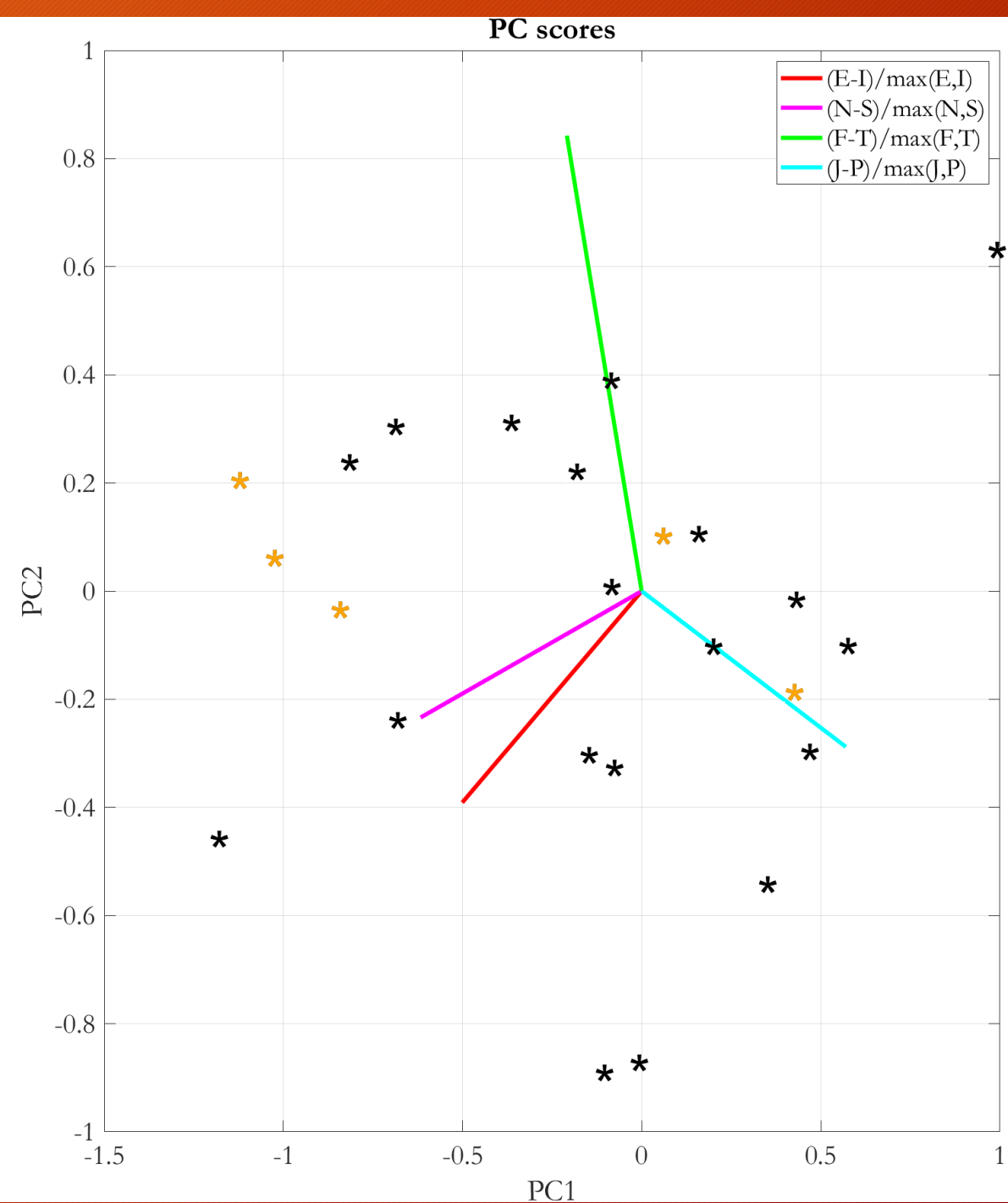
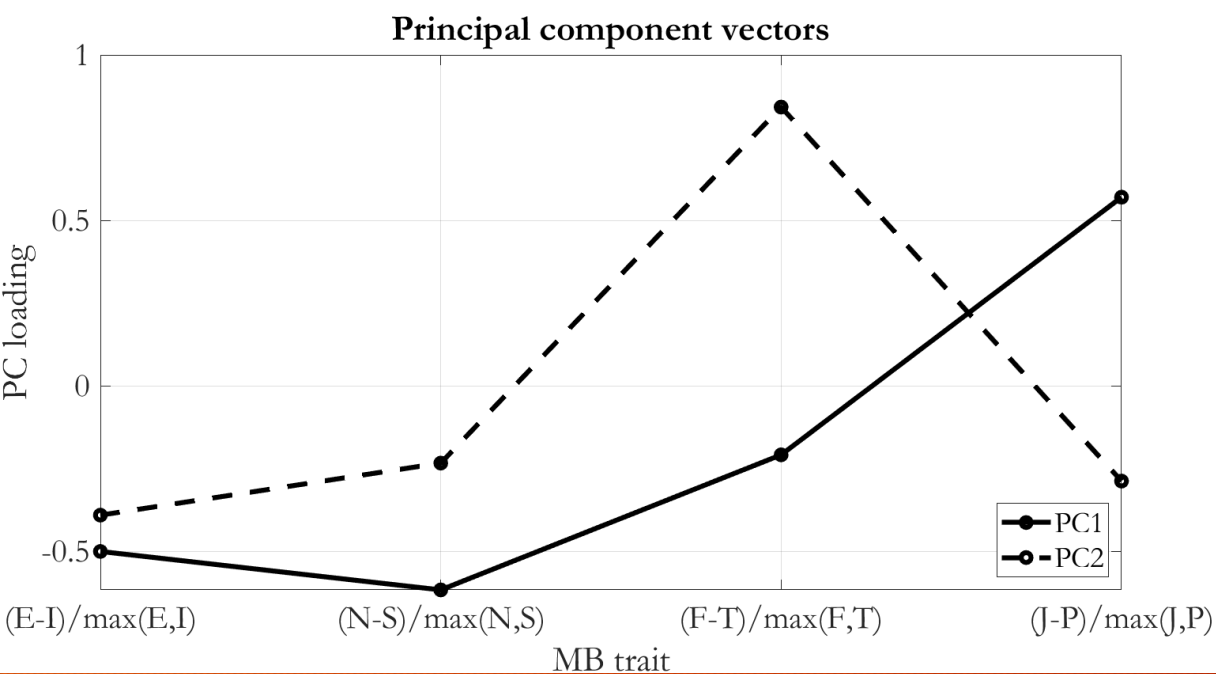
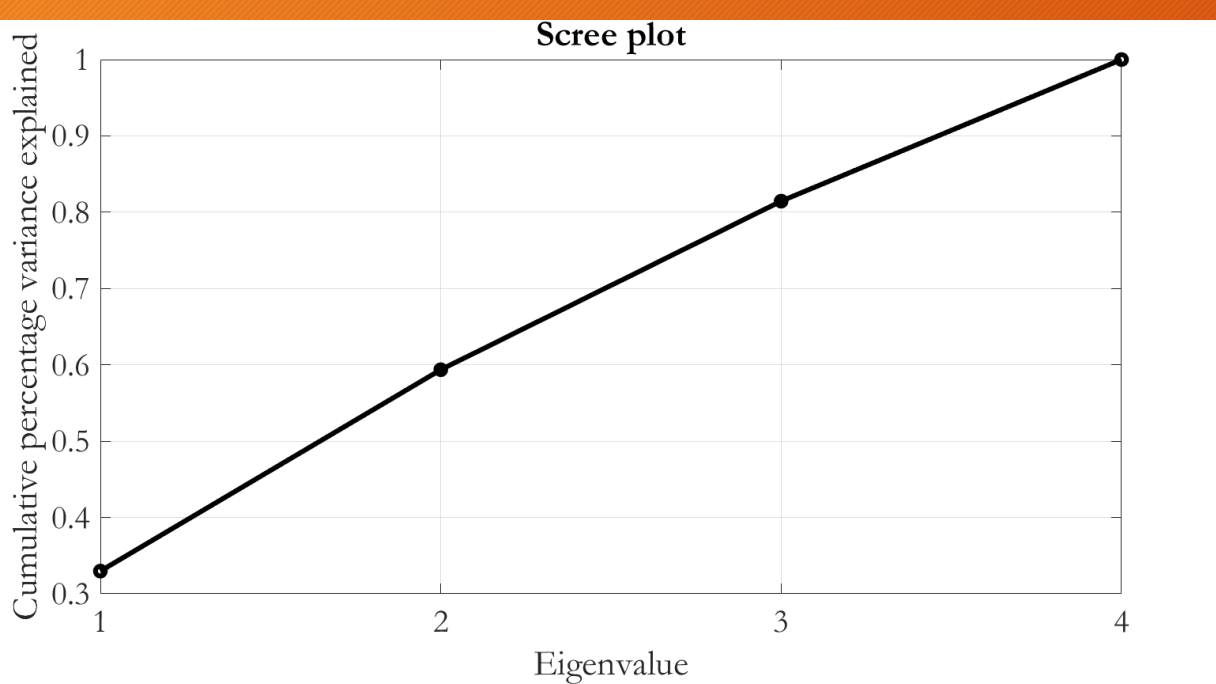


# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

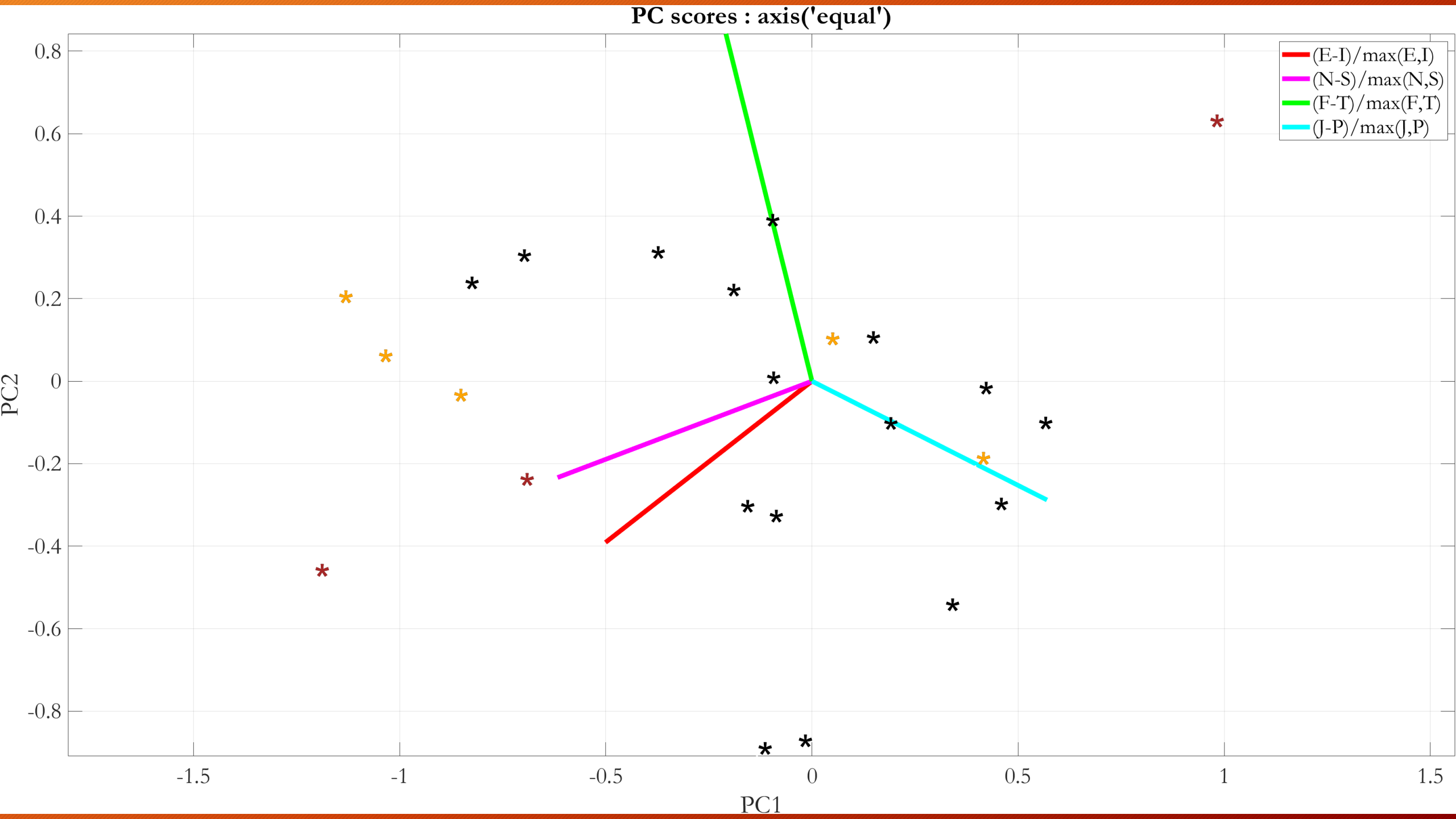
- 19+5 respondents
  - 12+5 students (“+5” == 2026 group)
  - 7 academic and admin staff
- Scaled difference for each trait
  - $(A-B)/\max(A,B)$
  - For each of (A,B) pairs (E,I), (N,S), (F,T) and (J,P)
- What do you think the answers will look like?
  - Do you think you're more like some folks than others?
- Remember this is a bit of fun, but there's some thinking behind it!

# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)









# TypeFinder (introductory Myers-Briggs)

- Isabel Briggs Myers and her mother Katharine Briggs (US, in WW2)
- Over 50,000,000 official tests done
- What do you think?
- What does the analysis tell you about working with others?
  - Who is like you?
  - Who is different to you?
- Will you behave differently in future?

# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

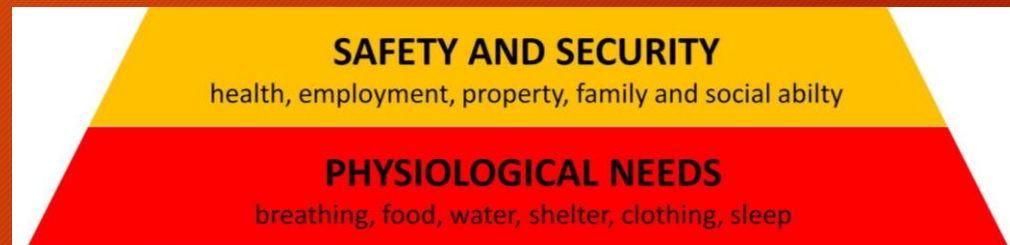
- Can we order our needs?
- Maslow's hierarchy goes from the most basic to the most advanced needs.
- Higher needs in the hierarchy begin to emerge when people feel they have sufficiently satisfied the previous need.
- What do you think the ordered components might be, from the most fundamental?

# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

## **PHYSIOLOGICAL NEEDS**

breathing, food, water, shelter, clothing, sleep

# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)





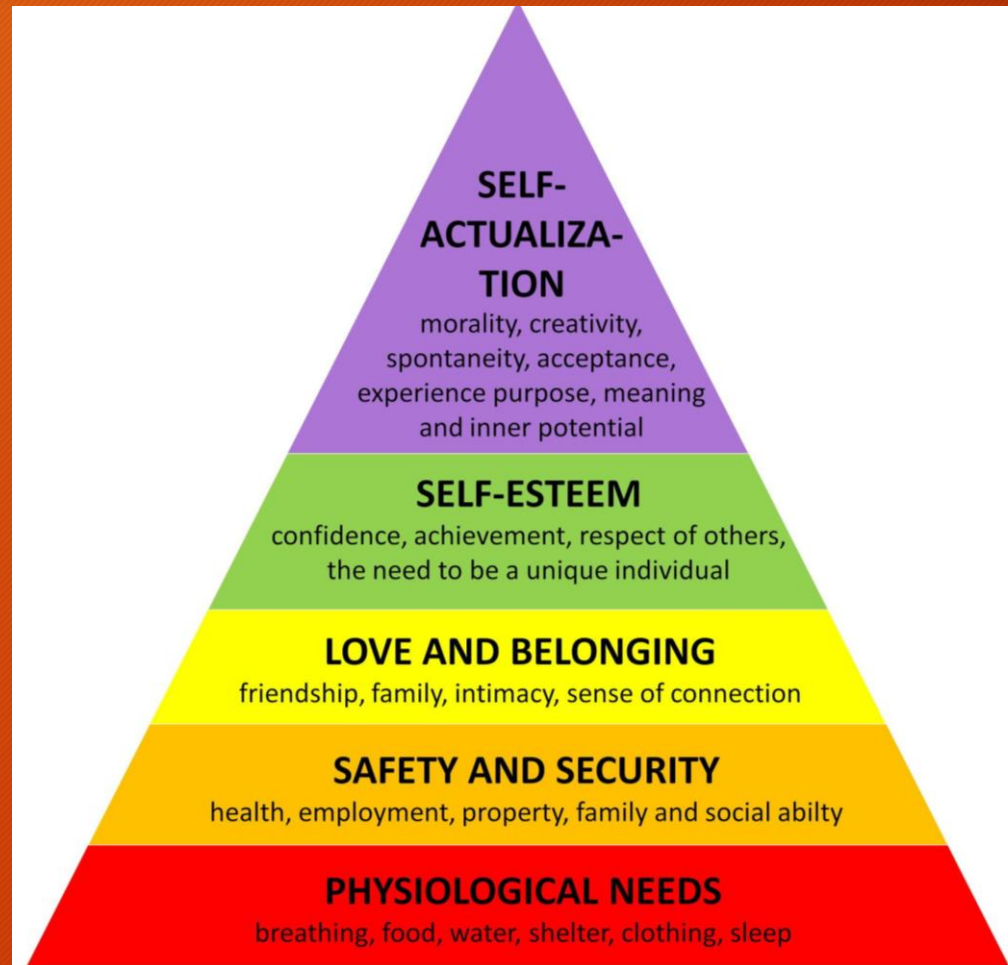
# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)



# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)





# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

- Abraham Maslow (US, 1943; positive “humanist” psychologist)
- Comments?

# Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

## Self-actualisation

- Truth: honest, reality, beauty, pure, clean and unadulterated completeness
- Goodness: rightness, desirability, uprightness, benevolence, honesty
- Beauty: rightness, form, aliveness, simplicity, richness, wholeness, perfection, completion,
- Wholeness: unity, integration, tendency to oneness, interconnectedness, simplicity, organization, structure, order, not dissociated, synergy
- Dichotomy-transcendence: acceptance, resolution, integration, polarities, opposites, contradictions
- Aliveness: process, not-deadness, spontaneity, self-regulation, full-functioning
- Uniqueness: idiosyncrasy, individuality, non comparability, novelty
- Perfection: nothing superfluous, nothing lacking, everything in its right place, just-rightness, suitability, justice
- Necessity: inevitability: it must be just that way, not changed in any slightest way
- Completion: ending, justice, fulfillment
- Justice: fairness, suitability, disinterestedness, non partiality,
- Order: lawfulness, rightness, perfectly arranged
- Simplicity: abstract, essential skeletal, bluntness
- Richness: differentiation, complexity, intricacy, totality
- Effortlessness: ease; lack of strain, striving, or difficulty
- Playfulness: fun, joy, amusement
- Self-sufficiency: autonomy, independence, self-determining

What can we really know and understand?



# What can we really know and understand?

- How do you know you exist?

# What can we really know and understand?

- How do you know you'll wake up tomorrow morning?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Is there a God?



# What can we really know and understand?

- Does the central limit theorem work everywhere in the universe?

# What can we really know and understand?

- What happened before the Big Bang? Was there a Big Bang?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Can you ever prove causality?



# What can we really know and understand?

- What is free will?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to kill one person, if by doing so you avoid 10 people being killed?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to eat meat?



# What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to work for an “oil company”, or a bank, or for “big tech”, or the Conservative Party?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Why did so many people in the US support Donald Trump II for President?

# What can we really know and understand?

- Is it OK to be spending your days studying for a PhD at Lancaster when you could be helping “save lives in Africa”?



# What can we really know and understand?

- Many things are beyond our comprehension
- Many things are unanswerable
- Any estimates we make lean strongly on “our priors”
- Our different “nature” and “nurture” mean we can have quite different views on many topics to others
- No “right” or “wrong”, just “different”
- What does this mean for leadership?

What makes a “good” or “bad” leader?

# What makes a “good” leader?

|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                            | Ensure every person is heard, valued, and encouraged to contribute                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                                            | Communicate clear goals, direction, and expectations so everyone stays aligned                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|                                            | Provide constructive feedback that helps others improve and stay motivated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Aragorn (from Lord of the Rings)           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>He inspires everyone around him</li><li>Even though he is (hierarchically) above other people, he treats everyone with respect and doesn't treat them as inferior</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Alan Bates (Post Office Horizon scandal)   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>He showed determination and resilience for a very long time in order to achieve what he wanted to, which encouraged other people to do the same</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| A conductor of a brass band I have been in | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>She treats everyone respectfully and makes decisions with clarity. She encourages people to work hard and improve their music ability, which makes everyone, as a group, stronger.</li><li>She also celebrates people's achievements, which makes people aware that she is a personable person and that she values people's individual successes.</li></ul>                                                          |
| Jon Tawn                                   | Jon is very likeable. He speaks to every student, whether international or local. When I had dinner with him, he made a real effort to include everyone at the table in the conversation and to help people who were not yet familiar with one another connect. Although he is highly respected in academia, he is very down-to-earth and never puts on airs.                                                                                              |
| Cai Yuanpei                                | He is the president of the Peking University. He created an environment where talented people could think freely. He supported the idea that a university should allow different schools of thought to coexist, rather than forcing everyone to follow one ideology. He hired people with different views, supported women's education and believed education should develop character, not just technical skill.                                          |
| Zhang Haibo                                | She is a judge. She was responsible for hearing a criminal case in which a man was found murdered in his home, and his mistress, Tao Xue, was accused by the police as the suspect. All the evidence presented by the police pointed to her, but the judge noticed several inconsistencies. Under tremendous pressure, she led the court staff to reopen the investigation, and after discovering more doubts in the case, she acquitted Tao Xue in court. |

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | As a result, the victim's family defamed her online. However, two years later, the real murderer was unexpectedly caught. This judge upheld the principle of presumption of innocence in cases of reasonable doubt. Her wisdom, courage, and persistence are worthy of admiration.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Margaret Thatcher          | This is not a commendation of the women, her government, or the policies she inflicted on this country. However, putting my personal politics aside, I think that she had some attributes which made her an excellent leader: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>She had a clear vision</li><li>She was able to express this vision in a narrative which was comprehensible and resonated with a large enough segment of the <u>uk</u> population.</li><li>She was decisive.</li></ul> Having a vision and being confident and proactive in bringing that vision about is what I think makes a good leader.                                                            |
| My brother's cricket coach | The attributes which make one good at running a sports team are very different to those which help one run a country. I don't know any famous football managers, or anything like that. My brother has told me a bit about his cricket coach: <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Consciences about each team members strengths and weaknesses.</li><li>Encouraging towards his team. He helps boost morale if players make mistakes.</li><li>Patient during training.</li></ul> What these traits help encourage is player morale, I think <u>its</u> much easier to get a team to perform well, if all the players feel good, or feel empowered to get the task done. |
| Nelson Mandela             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Abraham Lincoln            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Mahatma Gandhi             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |



# What makes a “bad” leader?

|  |                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |                                                      | Focus on personal gain or control, often at the expense of the group/country                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|  |                                                      | Create confusion or division through poor, unclear, or misleading communication, e.g. changing direction or policies without people knowing/or a clear reason why.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|  |                                                      | Avoid accountability, blaming others instead of taking responsibility for mistakes/not addressing them.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|  | Dolores Umbridge (from Harry Potter)                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>She tried to lead people by making them fear her, rather than respecting her. I think fearing someone that you are meant to be led by doesn't make you want to work with them and also doesn't encourage people to work at their best.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|  | My secondary school head teacher                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>He was almost invisible at the school and didn't put effort into knowing any students. I understand being a head teacher means you are a “leader” of a large number of students, but it is important for people who are working under the leader to feel that the leader cares and is present.</li> <li>He would not show up at some achievement events, such as award ceremonies and results days. This can make people in the team you are leading feel as if they are just there to work for you rather than with you, and that they don't really care about your own achievements.</li> </ul> |
|  | A different conductor of a brass band I have been in | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>He would make some very important decisions that impacted members of the band without any consultation. Being a good leader should involve having good communication with everyone you are working with, which was not the case.</li> <li>He wanted people to always be “accountable”, but when he did things that hurt other people, he would blame them and come up with excuses rather than being accountable himself. I think it a leader doesn't lead by <u>example</u>, it is hard for the team to respect them.</li> </ul>                                                                 |
|  | Mao Zedong                                           | The way he used to manage people was to mobilize the masses to struggle against one another. He had lost his humanity and lacked even the most basic human compassion. He used the Cultural Revolution as a mean to eliminate his opponents. He deified himself, made people praise him, and used communism as a cover to oppress and exploit the people.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

|  |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Jack Ma           | He said things like “996 is a blessing.” (996 means working from 9am to 9pm every day and working 6 days per week). He believed that Alibaba had provided employees with job opportunities, and that employees should be deeply grateful for this, no matter how unreasonable their working hours were.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|  | Donald Trump      | He has no moral bottom line and will do whatever it takes to serve his own interests. His extreme narcissism makes him put himself above basic principles, truth, and responsibility.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|  | Margaret Thatcher | The traits that make one a good leader in some regards, can also become a hindrance in others. Thatcher was famous for being domineering, a bully and she neglected to listen to her cabinet and advisors. These attributes may lead to the type of person who has <u>drive</u> , and a clear vision, but if left unchecked - either through a lack of awareness, or a disregard for others - they can quickly bring about the destruction of themselves or those around them.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|  | Donald Trump      | An unoriginal choice maybe, but an easy one to talk about. As with the other leaders on this list, this is not a criticism or approval of what his government has done. He is domineering in a similar way to thatcher, but he just lacks any intelligence or any ability to see outside of himself. Donald Trump does not serve the America, or the Republican Party, or even anyone else in his <u>ever changing</u> circle of allies. He just looks out only for himself. He is very corrupt, and compulsively fires or backstabs his allies.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|  | Keir Starmer      | This is a joke, but I am not actually sure he is the leader of the Labour party. I would say he is the worst of this list, because the others were able to get the things done that they wanted to do - for better or for worse. Keir Starmer is <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a ditherer.</li> <li>A Backstabber, in that he frequently betrays his own party members and the people who supported him.</li> <li>He changes his mind frequently. Which isn't inherently a bad thing, as it shows that one is self-aware enough to reflect on their stances and update them if new information contradicts them. It is just a shame that Keir never had any principles or stances to begin with.</li> <li>And finally, he is a terrible judge of character q.v. the <u>Mandleson</u> saga.</li> </ul> |
|  | Adolf Hitler      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|  | Joseph Stalin     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|  | Pol Pot           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

# What makes a “good” or “bad” leader?

- Thoughts?
- Do you think you would make a good leader?
  - Why?
  - Why not?

What are the key leadership traits?



# What are the key leadership traits?



# What are the key leadership traits?



What is leadership meant to achieve?

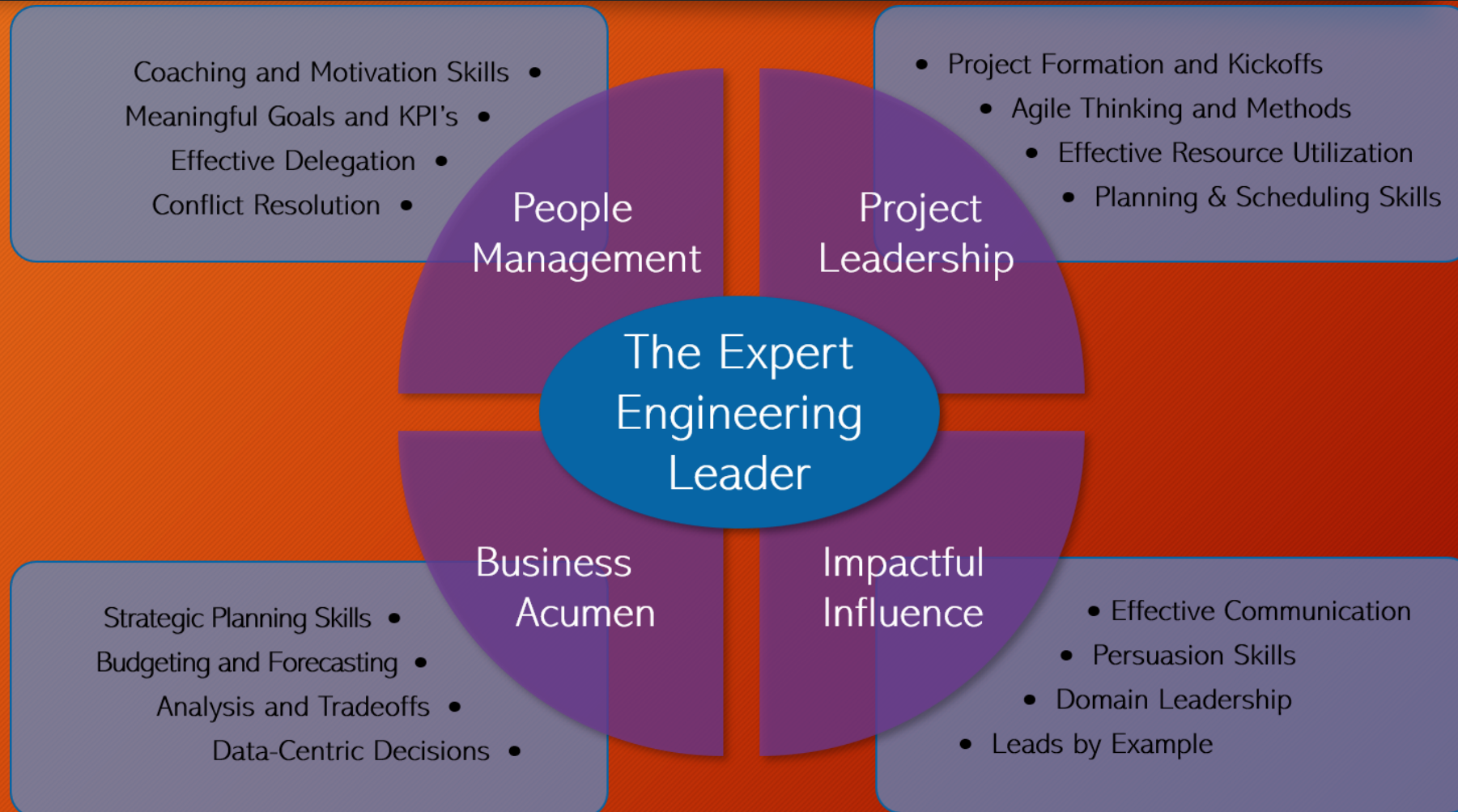


# What is leadership meant to achieve?



The Expert  
Engineering  
Leader

# What is leadership meant to achieve?



What is leadership like in practice?



# What is leadership like in practice?

- Leadership styles
- Key things to get right?
- What typically goes wrong?
- Coping strategies for leadership stress

# Leadership styles

# Leadership styles

## DEFINITION

A leadership style encompasses the leader's behaviors, attitudes, and actions in influencing and directing others towards achieving common goals. Different leadership styles exist, ranging from autocratic to democratic, and can vary in terms of decision-making authority, communication style, level of involvement, and focus on relationship building.



# Leadership styles

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A leadership style encompasses the leader's behaviors, attitudes, and actions in influencing and directing others towards achieving common goals. Different leadership styles exist, ranging from autocratic to democratic, and can vary in terms of decision-making authority, communication style, level of involvement, and focus on relationship building.

## EXAMPLES

- Autocratic leadership
- Democratic leadership
- Transformational leadership
- Transactional leadership
- Laissez-faire leadership
- Servant leadership
- Charismatic leadership
- Bureaucratic leadership
- Situational leadership
- Coaching leadership

Key things to get right?

# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best



# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
  - Work in a way that is most fun for you, “generating energy”
  - Adopt your optimal leadership and working style
  - Be a black hole for the rubbish, but radiate the good stuff around!
  - Wear a “yes face”

# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals

# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
  - Walk the talk - practice what you preach - behave the way you want your team to behave
  - Be as honest and open with the team as possible
  - Work for the best interests of the whole team, even the ones you find it harder to get along with
  - "Work with and through others"



# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team

# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team
  - Take responsibility for setting success factors that work for all “stakeholders”
  - Take responsibility to ensure these are achieved
  - Be the “external face” of the team
  - Be the “gap-filler” and “glue” of the team

# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
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- “Own” the key success factors for your team
- Keep your colleagues happy



# Key things to get right?

- Make sure you're ready and able to contribute at your best
- Be first amongst equals
- “Own” the key success factors for your team
- Keep your colleagues happy
  - Help your team members be ready and able to contribute at their best
  - Make sure you team has enough work to do
  - Manage individual performance of team members
  - Recruitment and retention for team
  - Facilitate “next steps” for team members (outside the team)
  - Training and mentoring for team

What typically goes wrong?

# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?



# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
  - People have different abilities and needs
  - One person's "dream project" can be a "mill stone" for another
  - Your leadership style might naturally favour some team members
  - Finding the right balance is tricky ... it's all "observer dependent"

# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors

# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
  - Bureaucracy
  - “HR rules”
  - “Reorganisation”
  - “Events, my dear boy, events” (Harold Macmillan, UK PM 1957-1963)



# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences

# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
  - Under-performing staff
  - Unwillingness to compromise

# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
- Personal workload



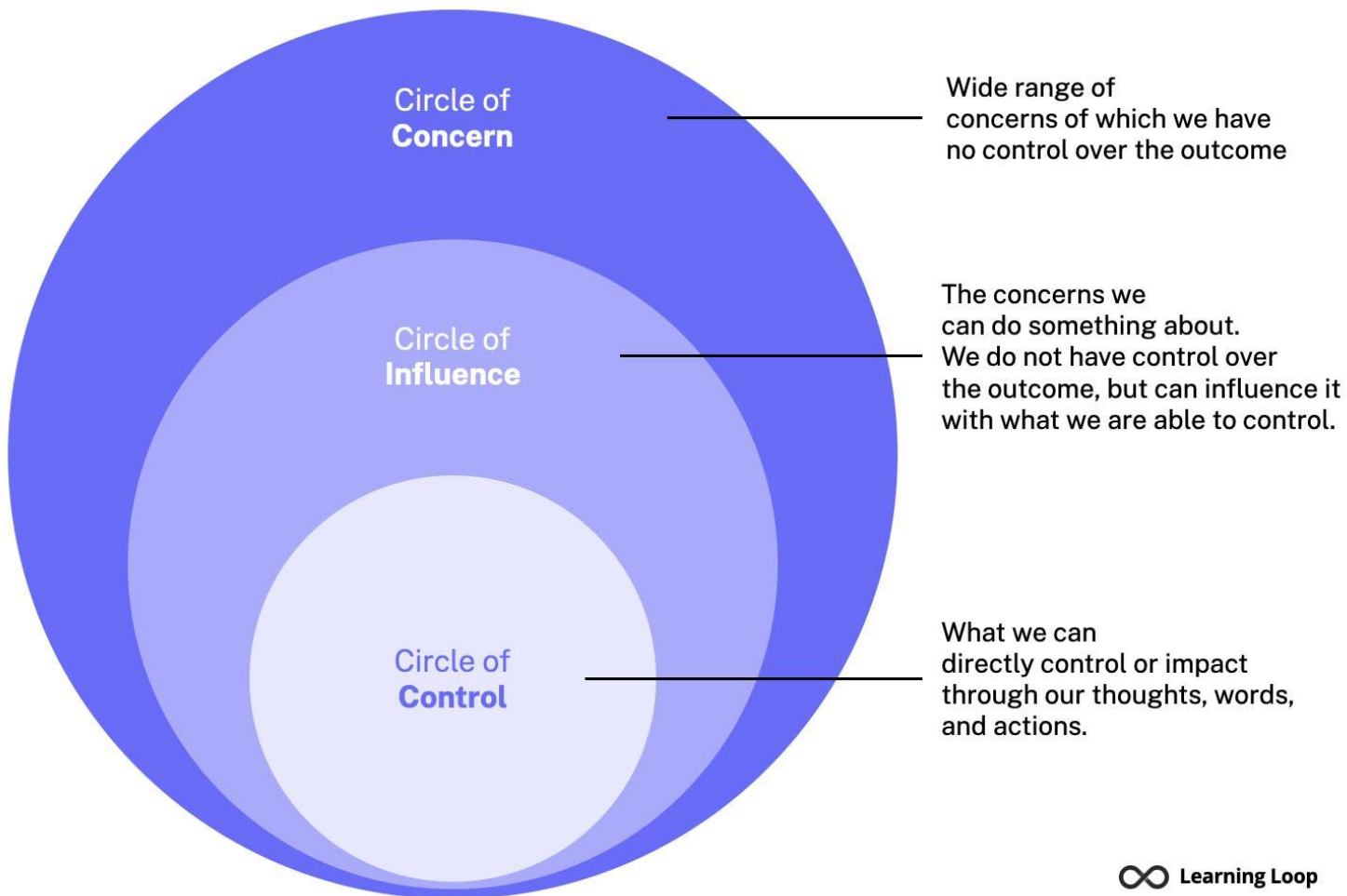
# What typically goes wrong?

- Is treating everyone the same a good idea?
- “External” or “uncontrollable” factors
- Irreconcilable differences
- Personal workload
  - “Victim of own success”
  - Failure to delegate
  - Over-commitment to projects and people

# Coping strategies for leadership stress

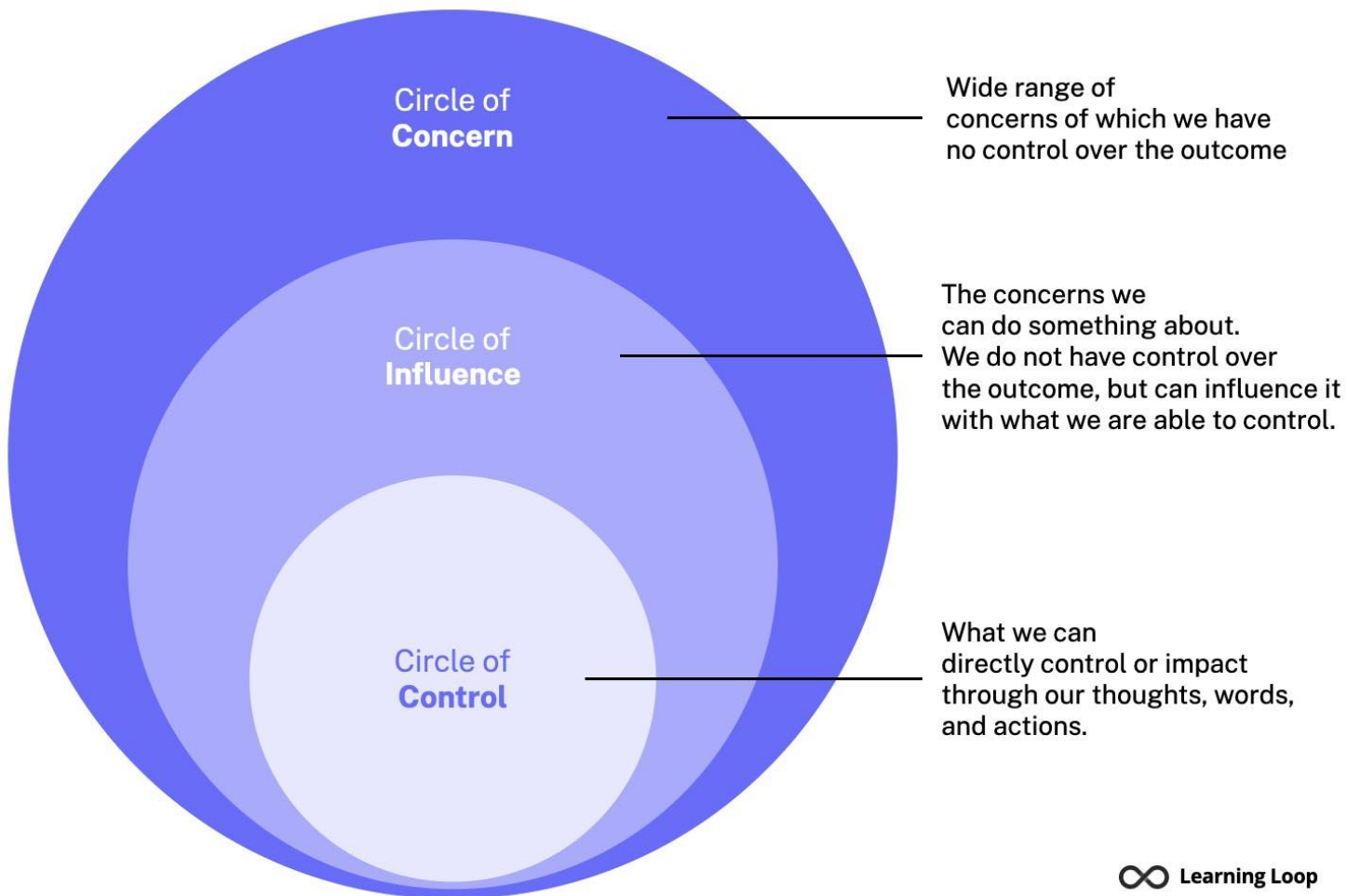
- A sense of perspective

# Coping strategies for leadership stress





# Coping strategies for leadership stress



## Wellbeing and your belief system



# Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
  - Spheres of control, influence and concern
  - Be faithful to your “belief system”
  - Remember: it’s just a job

# Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to



# Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to
  - A senior colleague “who’s seen it all before”
  - Share your concerns openly

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- Don't give up on the good stuff

# Coping strategies for leadership stress

- A sense of perspective
- A safe space, and trusted people to talk to
- Don't give up on the good stuff
  - There's a tendency to sacrifice the “fun” stuff when under pressure; this is exactly the wrong thing to do!
  - Hobbies, sports, friends and relationships



To “be” and “work” best for myself and others?



Have a sense  
of wonder.



Stay inspired.



Help others.



Do things you're  
good at.



Read books.



Limit television.



Love your work.



Exercise.



Face your fears.



Believe in yourself.



Stay close to  
friends and family.



Let your heart  
be your guide.









# Take-aways

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  - So don't expect rigour!
  - Soft skills are important



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- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
- There are basic concepts it's good to know about
  - Most of these are “common sense”
  - But knowing the terminology and frameworks used is good as a basis for rational learning and communication
  - A Management School can give you chapter and verse!

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# Take-aways

- Leadership is art (or at best soft science), not maths or physics
- There are basic concepts it's good to know about
- We all exercise leadership skills all the time
- If you take a “leadership role” in your work life:
  - It can be fun and rewarding
  - Take it seriously, but not too seriously
  - Try to do the best for everyone in your team without exception
  - Look around and identify the leaders you respect most, and learn from them; but most of all, be true to yourself
  - Keep doing the fun stuff